



IN THIS GUIDE

- The Interview Guide provides you with steps and tips for every step of the interview process - beginning with how to review a resume/application to suggested interview questions for the phone interview and in-person interview. Additionally, in this guide are email and phone templates as well as a new hire checklist.
- S/B/O Questions**
- Most of the questions included are Situation/Behavior/Outcome Based questions. About 80% of your questions should be S/B/O questions.
 - These recommended interview questions come from the SEB Master Interview Guide found in the Resource Center

INTERVIEW PROCESS

STEP 1

Review the application/resume and screen candidates

- Follow up with every candidate - whether you decide to move forward or not

STEP 2

Phone Interview (15-20 minutes)

- **INTRODUCTIONS (2-3 min.)** - Begin by introducing yourself and your role at the club. Invite them to share a little bit about themselves with the prompt, "Tell me a little bit about yourself and what you do at your current job (or previous role if not working currently)"
- **S/B/O BASED QUESTIONS (10 min.)** - This will take up the bulk of the interview process (see attached page with recommended questions)
- **SCHEDULE AND AVAILABILITY (2-3 min.)** - Check in with the applicant about their schedule and if it fits the needs of your club (check any club policies in place)
- **CLUB CULTURE AND POSITION (2-3 min.)** - Discuss the position, starting wage, and club/AF culture
- **REMAINING QUESTIONS (2-3 min.)** - Address any of their questions
- **FOLLOW UP!** - Whether you decide to move forward or not, follow up with the candidate via email/ phone within 5-7 business days

STEP 3

In Person Interview (20-30 minutes)

- **INTRODUCTIONS (2-3 min.)** - Introduce yourself again and work to build rapport/help them feel comfortable
- **S/B/O BASED QUESTIONS (15 min.)** - Remind them about S/B/O questions
- **SCHEDULE AND AVAILABILITY (2-3 min.)** - Clarify any questions you have regarding their schedule or if anything has changed
- **CLUB CULTURE AND POSITION (2-3 min.)** - Remind them of the position, wage, hours, and growth opportunities
- **REMAINING QUESTIONS (2-3 min.)** - Address any of their questions
- **FOLLOW UP!** - Whether you decide to move forward or not, follow up with the candidate via email/ phone within 5-7 business days

REMINDERS

- **80/20 Rule** - the candidate should talk 80% of the time, interviewer should talk 20%
- **Keep your questions specific to the job!** Ensure your interview process is EEOC compliant and you are asking legally defensible questions
- **Avoid leading or overly personal questions** when you probe for additional information

INTERVIEW GUIDE

for Personal Trainers

STEP 1: REVIEW RESUME & APPLICATION



Before interviewing any candidate, take a moment to review their resume/cover letter and application. Mark "Yes" or "No" as you review the application/resume and decide whether or not to move the candidate to the next round.

1 Skim the resume for keywords and specifics skills that align with the job description posted. Keywords include (add more as you they apply to your club):

- | | | |
|-----------------------|-------------|---|
| • Instruct/Train | • Motivate | • |
| • Customer Service | • Fitness | • |
| • Active Listening | • Health | • |
| • Service Orientation | • Nutrition | • |

2 Deep dive into skills and qualifications.

- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| • Are their skills and qualifications relevant to the role you're looking to fill? | YES | NO |
| • Compare their list of skills to the job requirements and consider any gaps. Do you and your club have the time and resources to train in on those gaps? | YES | NO |

3 Thoroughly review previous employment

- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| • Will their previous job titles and primary duties fulfill the responsibilities outlined in the job description? | YES | NO |
| • Are there any gaps in employment or short stints that you're curious about? Consider asking the candidate to expand or explain if you decide to move them on to the next round. | YES | NO |

4 Determine if the applicant qualifies for the next phase

- | | | |
|--|-----|----|
| • After reviewing the candidate's resume and application, would you recommend moving forward with their application? | YES | NO |
| • If yes, what questions do you have that are specific to their resume that you would like to ask? Make a note. | | |

5 Schedule Phone Interview*

- If you decide to move forward with the applicant, schedule a phone interview. The phone interview should take 15-20 minutes.
- AF TIP: If you decide not to move forward, send an email or rejection letter to demonstrate excellent customer service to a potential member of your club!



1 Introductions (2-3 minutes)

2 Interview Questions (10 minutes)

Resume/Application - Tell me about your current role and job responsibilities. What do you enjoy most about your current role/job?

Candidate Info - What do you consider your strenghts? What are your biggest weaknesses? Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

AF Interest - What brings you to Anytime Fitness? What about the company is appealing? Out of all of the candidates, why are you the best fit?

Time Management- Tell me about a time you had to balance the needs of the people around you with the critical job tasks. What were the demands of the people? How did that interfere with your work? How did you prioritize the needs of others with the tasks at hand? What happened?

Developing Others - Share with me a time when you successfully motivated someone to achieve their goals and/or enhance their skills. What was the situation? How did you motivate them? What was their response? What skills did they gain? What would you do differently?

Customer Service - Tell me about a time when you significantly exceeded the expectations of a customer. What did the customer expect? What did you do to make this happen? How did this affect the relationship with the customer?

Empathy Based - Tell me about a time when you had to support someone who was frustrated with a work or fitness goal. How could you tell the person was frustrated? What did you do? What was the result?

Additional Information - What do you feel I need to know that we haven't discussed?

3 Discuss schedule and availability (2-5 minutes)

4 Describe the position available and company culture (2-5 minutes)

5 Answer any questions they might have (2-5 minutes)

Let them know when they can expect to hear from you



1 Introductions (2-3 minutes)

2 Interview Questions (10-15 minutes) - include additional questions as needed

AF Related/General - What about this role do you find appealing, especially after we spoke on the phone? What kind of work environment do you like best? If you got the job, what can we expect from you in your first three months?

General - What is a common misperception people have of you?

Customer Service - Share an example of a time when you developed customer trust and respect during a difficult time. What was the situation? What actions did you take to build and maintain the customer's trust and respect? What was the outcome?

Motivating Others - Tell me about a time you worked with someone who was demotivated. What was the situation? What did you do? What was the impact?

Action Oriented - Tell me about a time that you were tired or burnt out - yet still approached the job with energy and enthusiasm. What was the situation? Why were you burnt out? What did you do to correct this? What was the result?

Self-Management - Tell me about a time when you lost patience with someone. What was the situation? How did you share your impatience? What happened?

Planning - Tell me about an assignment or project in which you set clear goals and successfully achieved them. What were the goals? What was the outcome? How did you measure success?

Drive for Results - Describe a situation where you went beyond the requirements of your job to accomplish a goal or objective. What was the situation? What was the outcome?

Motivating Others - Describe a time where you lifted someone out of a funk that was getting in the way of their success. What was the situation? What did you do? How did you know what was needed? What was the outcome?

Action-Oriented - Tell me about a time when you were faced with a list of unchallenging tasks that you didn't really enjoy. What were the tasks? What did you do to maintain your energy and engagement? How well did you complete the tasks? What did you learn from the experience?

3 Clarify any questions regarding schedule/availability and expectations of the role (5 minutes)

4 Answer any questions they might have (2-5 minutes)

Let the candidate know when they can expect to hear from you



Review the following checklist before making a hiring decision

- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| • Did the candidate's responses meet expectations? | YES | NO |
| • Did they demonstrate competency accurately and consistently? | YES | NO |
| • Does the club/club staff have the time and resources needed to help them be successful? | YES | NO |
| • Does their schedule meet the needs of the club? | YES | NO |
| • Did they appear enthusiastic about the position? | YES | NO |
| • Will this candidate help drive the club's culture? | YES | NO |
| • Are there any red flags being overlooked because they fit the culture? | YES | NO |
| • Are there any doubts in hiring this candidate? | YES | NO |
| • Any remaining questions? | YES | NO |



SCHEDULING A PHONE INTERVIEW

Hi _____,

My name is _____ and I'm the [YOUR ROLE] at Anytime Fitness. I recently received your application and I was hoping to schedule a phone interview with you if you are still interested in the position. Does [DATE] at [TIME] work for a 15-30 minute interview? During the interview we'll touch base on your schedule, availability, interest in the role and time for me to get to know you better.

Before we connect for the phone interview, do you have any questions that I can answer right away?

EXPLAINING SITUATION/BEHAVIOR/OUTCOME BASED QUESTIONS

"The majority of the questions I will be asking you today are called, Situation/Behavior/Outcome Questions. What I will be looking for in your answers are a specific situation you were in, your behavior, and the outcome."

EMAIL/PHONE TEMPLATE - *not* moving forward with candidate

Hi _____,

Thank you so much for your interest in the [position] with Anytime Fitness. We appreciate you taking the time to visit our club and interview with us.

At this time, we have chosen to proceed with other candidates. We appreciate your time and wish you the best of luck in your future career endeavors.

Thank you,

EMAIL/PHONE TEMPLATE - moving forward with candidate

Hi _____,

Thank you so much for your interest in the [position] with Anytime Fitness. We appreciate you taking the time to visit our club and interview with us.

At this time, we'd love to offer you the position of [position] at [club location] with a starting wage of [wage]. Are you still interested in this position?

Next steps include [outline onboarding process]. Thank you,

AF Tip: Leverage your best customer service before, during and after the interview process. It's possible that a candidate becomes a member or a member becomes a candidate. Leverage your best customer service and work to create a positive experience for the individual. Some clubs include the following in their email if they decide to not move forward:

"Please keep us in mind for future opportunities and enjoy these two guest passes to our gym for you and a friend. A lot of our hires started as members and we would love for you to experience our culture and community."